

When a man is in distress: triage and referral

You lead education. You do not diagnose, counsel, or treat. This page is how you hold that line and still take care of the man.

WHAT YOU WATCH FOR

Watch behavior, not labels. A man who goes silent and stays silent across sessions. A man whose anger keeps rising past the practice. A man who stops sleeping, stops eating, or says so. A man who talks about not being here. You are not deciding what any of it means. You are deciding one thing: does this man need more than a fathering course tonight.

WHAT YOU DO, SAME DAY

1. Stay with him after the session. Two minutes, direct and calm: "I am glad you are here. Tonight I want to connect you with someone whose whole job is this part." No shame, no drama.
2. Hand him to the organization's named referral contact the same day. Walk him there or make the call together. A warm handoff, not a phone number on a card.
3. Tell your organization lead the same day. You never carry this alone.
4. If he speaks of harming himself or someone else, the organization's emergency protocol comes first and immediately. The course can wait.
5. He stays welcome. Getting help and finishing the course are not competitors. Most men do both.

COURTS, ORDERS, AND REBUILDING TRUST

Rebuilding trust never overrides a court order. Where a no-contact or protective order stands, the plan works within it: the man trains, the record builds, and contact follows the court's terms and nothing else. Never coach contact that an order forbids. If the arrangement is unclear, the organization confirms it before the plan touches it.

THE LINE, STATED ONCE MORE

You will sit with men carrying real weight. Your job is a steady room, a clear rhythm, and a fast, warm path to the people trained for the rest. That is not a smaller job. It is the one that makes the others possible.